

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Do Babies Communicate?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Before they can talk, babies communicate through their _____.
2	Their basic message is that adults are needed one hundred percent for _____.
3	Most early movements are not random; around 75% are _____.
4	These movements are also described as _____, even if they seem sudden to ordinary observers.
5	To the naked eye, babies' movements may look _____.
6	One purpose of these movements is to build _____ with parents.
7	Marie Derome's book is mainly written for _____.
8	Some parents expect an immediate feeling called _____.
9	Marie calls this idea an _____ because it can create unrealistic pressure.
10	Such expectations may make parents feel _____.

What is the main point made about newborn babies at the start of the discussion?

- A They mainly communicate because they want to copy adults.
- B They quickly learn spoken language by watching parents.
- C They depend on adults completely before they can speak.
- D They cry mostly when they are hungry or uncomfortable.

Why does Marie Derome use the phrase "one hundred percent" about babies?

- A To stress that babies' needs are total rather than partial.
- B To estimate how often babies communicate with parents.
- C To compare babies' survival chances in different families.
- D To show that newborn babies understand adults perfectly.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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What attitude does Marie show towards the idea that baby movements are meaningless?

- A She rejects it by saying the movements have a purpose.
- B She accepts it because the movements look uncontrolled.
- C She is uncertain because parents often misread babies.
- D She treats it as true only for very young newborns.

According to the discussion, why do babies move their arms and legs?

- A To practise the physical skills needed for walking.
- B To express discomfort when adults fail to feed them.
- C To show that their muscles are developing normally.
- D To attract parents and encourage emotional connection.

What contrast is made about babies' early movements?

- A They are faster in public than at home.
- B They seem jerky but are actually purposeful.
- C They look playful but usually show pain.
- D They appear simple but require special equipment to see.

What is Marie's view of "love at first sight" in parenting?

- A It is a reliable sign that parents are bonding well.
- B It is a useful goal for parents to work towards.
- C It can be an unhelpful expectation for new parents.
- D It happens naturally once babies begin to communicate.

In the phrase "these movements", what does "these" refer to?

- A Babies moving their arms and legs.
- B Parents learning body language.
- C Babies crying for food or care.
- D Adults speaking to newborn babies.

What can be inferred about bonding with a newborn baby?

- A It depends mainly on parents learning technical childcare skills.
- B It is easier when parents avoid thinking about expectations.
- C It should happen immediately if the parent is emotionally healthy.
- D It may develop gradually as parents get to know the baby.

Why is the phrase "to the naked eye" used in the explanation?

- A To suggest that parents need medical tests to understand babies.
- B To criticise ordinary people for observing babies carelessly.
- C To distinguish surface appearance from what is really happening.
- D To show that babies communicate mostly through eye contact.

What is the overall implication of the discussion?

- A Babies communicate clearly only after parents receive expert training.
- B Parents should see baby communication and bonding as gradual processes.
- C New parents usually misunderstand babies because they lack experience.
- D Baby movements are more important than crying in every situation.